

A Partnership Proposal *for Tilburg University*

A complementary platform built for students, employers, and TiU career services. A four-month parallel pilot proposal.

Prepared for Mick Timmermans · External Collaborations Manager, TiSEM

Dan Toma Poenaru, Founder · in collaboration with Prof. Cristian Dobre, TiSEM

May 2026

Students at TiU know the same twenty companies.

The other 1,200 Brabant SMEs that hire don't know how to reach them.

WHAT STUDENTS SEE

A small set of recognizable employers

Big-name corporates dominate visibility because they pay platform premium tiers. Boutique firms and SMEs that would gladly hire TiU students never appear in front of them. Students experience this as: "there are jobs, but only the same twenty companies keep showing up."

WHY THIS HAPPENS

It's a structural pricing problem

Existing career platforms monetize companies. Their pricing locks SMEs out by design — free posting tiers are gated to a handful of slots; premium is built for firms with 5+ hires per year. The result: small employers with real hiring needs cannot afford to be visible, and students lose access to the best part of the actual job market.

Three audiences, one platform.

What separates Rookies from existing platforms is not features — it is whom we design for.

FOR STUDENTS

A discovery surface

Every job presented by relevance. SMEs that other platforms hide are surfaced by default. The platform stays with them past placement. Mobile-native, profile-driven, no opt-in walls.

FOR EMPLOYERS

Direct, frictionless reach

Recruiters reach the right TiU students directly — ranked, transparent, one-click invite-to-apply. Small employers post freely without artificial caps. The platform Brabant boutique firms can actually use.

FOR CAREER SERVICES

A console for your team

A tool designed for daily 1-on-1 work. Match Analyzer turns advising sessions into coached conversations. Market Pulse keeps officers current. The platform supports the human work — never replaces it.

The platform doesn't replace the human work — it makes it sharper.

Five structural advantages.

Each one is a consequence of how we are organized — not a feature we copied. The next pages go deep on each.

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| 01 | Matching at the core | A match-first platform — designed around how students and employers actually search, with the engine present from day one. |
| 02 | Skills-gap intelligence for the AD's office | Real-time data on what employers search for vs. what TiU students have — to support accreditation, rankings, and strategic positioning. |
| 03 | SME accessibility — solving the supply problem | Open posting fixes the structural reason students see only the same twenty firms. |
| 04 | Direct outreach + Career Officer Console | Companies reach the right candidates directly. Career officers get a coaching console for 1-on-1 sessions. |
| 05 | Longitudinal outcome tracking | Placement signal continues past the application. Year-over-year data on which skills and paths actually deliver outcomes. |

Matching at the core.

Designed in from day one — and shaped to each institutional partner's context.

STANDARD APPROACH

Search-and-filter, scoring optional

- Browse, filter, apply — with no scoring layer between students and roles
- Matching, when offered, sits as an additional capability rather than the core experience
- Recruiter-side only — students don't see how they align with a role
- Single approach across all institutions — limited adaptation to local context

ROOKIES

Match-first experience

- Matching engine present across the platform, available to every user
- Bidirectional — students see roles by relevance, employers see candidates the same way
- Each match shows where the alignment sits — no black-box list
- Adapted to each institutional partner's context and priorities

Skills-gap intelligence for the AD's office.

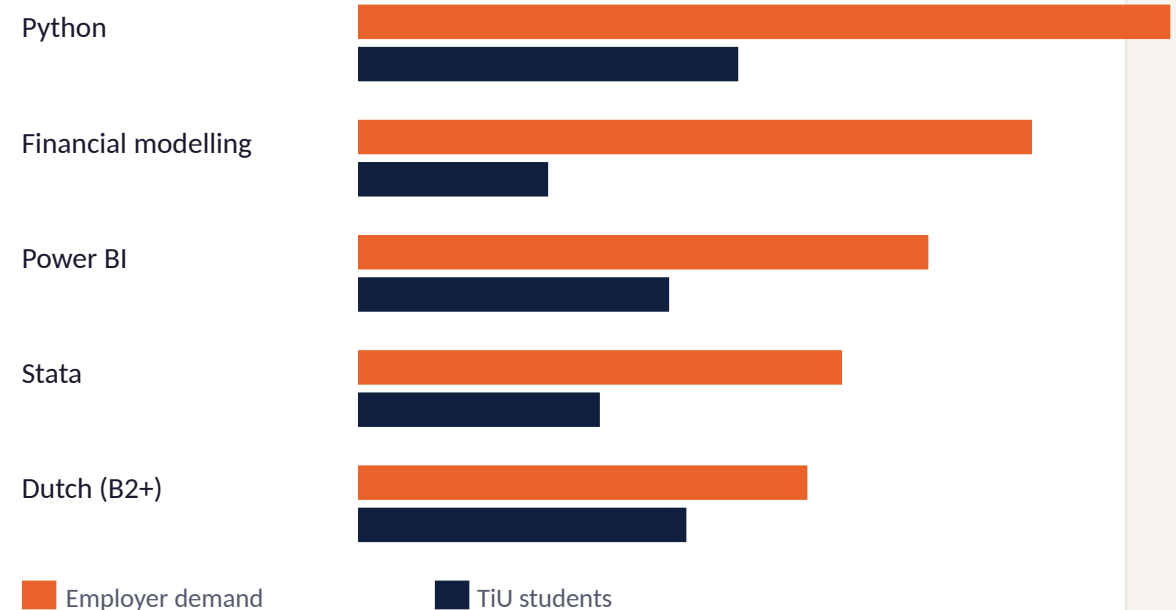
What employers actually search for, in real time, vs. what TiU students have. Strategic data — not engagement metrics.

What we surface

- Top skills employers searched at TiU this month, ranked
- Gap analysis: skills wanted vs. skills present in TiU profiles
- Sector-level demand trends — Technology, Finance, Sustainability, etc.
- Profile-completeness distribution — investment-readiness across cohorts
- Application funnel — profile → application → shortlisted → accepted

Why it matters: *supports the AD's office on accreditation reviews, rankings submissions, and external positioning — strategic data that existing platforms don't surface.*

TOP 5 UNMET SKILLS — TiU, MAY 2026



Mock data — actual numbers populate once the TiU pilot runs

SME accessibility — solving the supply problem.

Free unlimited posting for small employers fixes the structural cause of the "twenty companies" problem.

4 / yr

Industry standard NL free tier — postings per company across 4 institutions.

5+

Premium tier is gated for employers with at least 5 hires per year.

1,200+

SMEs in Brabant who don't fit either tier — and who don't post.

THE CONSEQUENCE — AND THE FIX

Boutique consulting firms, regional tech, sustainability orgs, mid-size industrials — most either don't post at all, or their listings get buried because well-capitalized corporates pay for promotion and dominate visibility. So TiU students see only the same well-funded names, and the matching problem the AD's office is asked to solve stays unsolved through the existing platform.

On Rookies, small employers post freely without artificial caps. The structural fix — by design.

Direct outreach + a Career Officer Console.

A two-sided platform that adds a third surface designed specifically for your team's daily work.

FOR EMPLOYERS

Recruiters reach the right student

- Browse with intent — filter by year, field, location, work auth
- Every active student visible — not an opt-in subset
- Match scores transparent — see why each candidate ranks
- One-click invite-to-apply with templated messages

FOR CAREER SERVICES

A console for your team's daily work

- Match Analyzer — pick a student + role; see gaps and coaching prompts
- Market Pulse — what employers want this month, ranked
- Career Path Explorer — what each role requires, who placed where
- Engagement view — students drifting before they slip through

The platform makes your team's 1-on-1 work sharper — never replaces it.

We don't lose the signal at placement.

The data trail keeps going past hire. Year-over-year, TiU sees what skills and paths actually deliver outcomes.

The data trail

- **Profile created**
Skills, background, preferences
- **Applications submitted**
What students went after
- **Match scores**
Where the algorithm thought they'd fit
- **Placements**
Where they actually landed — even off-platform
- **Outcome data**
Which skills and paths led to which roles

WHAT TIU GETS, OVER TIME

Real placement-outcome data

What % of TiU students placed, where, in which roles, in what timeframe — for accreditation reviews and rankings.

Skills-to-placement evidence

Which skills correlated with successful placements last year? Which didn't? Curriculum committees finally have data instead of anecdotes.

Industry drift over time

Year-over-year, what's gaining and what's cooling. See where the market is moving — and update what TiU teaches.

Where the existing platform is genuinely strong.

We don't try to compete on this surface. The case for Rookies is structural gaps — not feature parity.



Operational back-office

Real human team supporting career services daily. Mature, established, reliable.



Events and career-fair module

Posting, registration, attendance tracking — TiU runs Career Days through this.



ATS integrations

Connects to 100+ employer applicant-tracking systems with GDPR-compliant data flows.



Orientation tools

Proprietary career-guidance instruments with research backing — useful adjacencies.

Run Rookies in parallel during the pilot. Existing workflows don't change. We focus on the gaps — events, ATS, orientation tools stay where they are.

The Career Officer Console.

The single feature most relevant to TiSEM career services — designed around your team's daily work.

01 • IN-SESSION

Match Analyzer

Pick a student, pick a target role. See the score, the per-category breakdown, and templated coaching prompts under every weak category. Turns 1-on-1 advising into structured, evidence-based conversation.

02 • SITUATIONAL

Market Pulse

Real-time view of what employers searched for at TiU this month. Trending skills with week-over-week deltas. Hot roles. Sector demand. Career officers walk into sessions current on what's actually moving in the market.

03 • STRATEGIC

Career Path Explorer

Type a role — see the skills employers want, the common backgrounds that placed there, the preparation that lifts an application. Anchor career-direction conversations in evidence rather than anecdote.

04 • OPERATIONAL

Engagement view

Students with low profile completeness. Final-year cohorts with no applications submitted. Drifting students flagged before they slip through. Gives your team a triage queue, not just a dashboard.

Addressing the questions you raised.

Three direct answers to the points in your earlier note.

How do we acquire companies?

For the pilot, hand-to-hand. Target: 20–30 named employer partners onboarded across the pilot, drawn from three channels — our and Cristian's networks, regional partners (BOM, Brabantse Werkgevers Vereniging, MKB Brabant), and TiU-adjacent firms that already recruit through Career Week. Past pilot: references, sector outreach, eventually some inbound. We are not pretending to have a sales engine we don't have.

How is the back office set up? What support do you provide?

For the pilot: founder-led, direct phone, four-hour SLA on critical issues. We are not promising the 24/7 operational support of a 50-person vendor team — we will be more responsive than them during business hours and explicitly less so outside them. Past pilot, partnership funding pays for the team that scales support; we will say what we can and can't credibly deliver, and stick to that.

Have we considered TiU's processes are aligned with the existing platform?

Yes — and that's exactly why we're proposing a parallel pilot, not a switch. JobTeaser stays exactly where it is during the pilot. No workflow changes. No staff retraining. Rookies covers two specific gaps — SME accessibility and strategic data — that sit alongside, not on top of, the existing setup. After September, you decide whether the parallel layer earned its keep.

What we're proposing — concretely.

A four-month parallel pilot at TiSEM. Free for TiU. No exclusivity. Bounded downside.

TIMING

May → September

Setup: late May–early June. Active pilot: June–August. Retrospective: early September.
Decision on continuation: late September.

COST TO TIU

Free during pilot

TiU pays nothing during the pilot. No setup fees. No per-student fees. The post-pilot conversation is co-designed with the AD's office based on what the data shows — not anchored on numbers we set today.

STRUCTURE

Parallel, not replacement

The existing platform stays in place. Existing workflows are unchanged. Rookies operates alongside, focused on SME accessibility and strategic data. Bounded downside — TiU can withdraw at any time.

Success metrics agreed in writing with TiSEM up front: profiles, postings, applications, dashboard cadence, end-of-pilot NPS.

What we ask • what TiU gets.

A bounded ask in exchange for a bounded set of strategic deliverables.

WHAT WE'D ASK OF TIU

A partnership, not a transaction.

- Permission to display the TiU logo as founding-partner platform
- An optional short press release or news item if TiU is comfortable with one — nothing that requires staff effort
- A named operational point of contact in your office
- Introductions to relevant employer relationships you'd vouch for
- Engagement with the AD's office on success-metric definition

WHAT TIU GETS

Strategic data and a working tool.

- Skills-gap intelligence dashboard for the AD's office
- Career Officer Console for TiSEM career services daily work
- Access to the SME and boutique-firm employer pool we onboard
- Founding-partner status — early shaping of the platform's evolution
- End-of-pilot data set — placement, engagement, demand

No funding • No exclusivity • No replacement of existing systems.

Who's behind this.

A small founding team with operational roots inside TiU.



FOUNDER

Dan Toma Poenaru

MSc Business Analytics & Operations Research, Tilburg University. Builds the platform. Operational lead during the pilot.



FOUNDING ENGINEER

Tudor Poenaru

BSc Computer Science and Engineering. Front-end and product engineering. Broader hires post-pilot if the partnership justifies them.

ACADEMIC SPONSOR

Dr. Cristian Dobre

Associate Professor, Department of Econometrics and Operations Research • Master Academic Director, Business Analytics and Operations Research, TiSEM.

The next step we're asking for

Small. Specific. No commitment beyond a conversation.

0 1

A written response

A short follow-up addressing any remaining questions, within 48 hours.

0 2

An AD-level conversation

If it makes sense to you, the next step is the conversation with Herbert and the AD's office.

0 3

A pilot draft

If that moves forward, we co-author a one-page MoU — success metrics, timeline, scope.

We're not asking for funding. We're not asking for endorsement today. We're asking whether this is worth the next conversation.

Founding-partner conversations like this
are how every category-defining platform begins.

Thank you for the time, the questions, and the perspective.

Dan Toma Poenaru

danpoenaru107@gmail.com · In collaboration with Prof. Cristian Dobre, TiSEM